

THE ALLURE OF ALIA

SHE ALWAYS KNEW SHE WAS BORN TO BE A STAR. NOW, THE WORLD KNOWS IT TOO. ALIA BHATT HAS ARRIVED, AND HOW

By **SUHANI SINGH**

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

It's a Sunday afternoon on Floor #1 of Mehboob Studios, and Alia Bhatt is biting into multiple bars of Perk. Dressed in white vest, sunshine yellow bomber jacket and denims, you could mistake the 29-year-old for a teen. Except that we are in the presence of 'India's new acting superstar', a term INDIA TODAY had first coined for her now boyfriend of five years, Ranbir Kapoor, in 2013. That label sits well on Alia too today, but then, she, as always, likes to play it cool. "I have to observe, without it seeming like acting," she says, of her Perk shoot, but it may well be her life's credo. The chocolate is one of 23 brands the actor currently endorses. There cannot be a better fit for their brand, believes Monosij Bandyopadhyay, category marketing manager, chocolates, at Mondelez International, given her "girl-next-door image" and "immense popularity with teens and young adults".